

Daily Bible Note

Date: July 22, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 28:20-26

20 Then the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

21 "Son of man, set your face toward Sidon, and prophesy against her,

22 and say, 'Thus says the Lord God: "Behold, I am against you, O Sidon; I will be glorified in your midst; And they shall know that I am the Lord, When I execute judgments in her and am hallowed in her.

23 For I will send pestilence upon her, And blood in her streets; The wounded shall be judged in her midst By the sword against her on every side; Then they shall know that I am the Lord.

24 And there shall no longer be a pricking brier or a painful thorn for the house of Israel from among all who are around them, who despise them. Then they shall know that I am the Lord God."

25 'Thus says the Lord God: "When I have gathered the house of Israel from the peoples among whom they are scattered, and am hallowed in them in the sight of the Gentiles, then they will dwell in their own land which I gave to My servant Jacob.

26 And they will dwell safely there, build houses, and plant vineyards; yes, they will dwell securely, when I execute judgments on all those around them who despise them. Then they shall know that I am the Lord their God.'""

II. Key Summary

- God tells Ezekiel to prophesy against Sidon, declaring "I am against you," and saying He will be glorified and shown as holy in her midst so that people will know He is the Lord.
- The passage spells out what the judgment looks like: pestilence sent into Sidon, blood in her streets, the wounded falling in her midst, and the sword coming against her on every side.

- God then says that those around Israel who despise her will no longer be a pricking brier or a painful thorn; He will gather the scattered house of Israel back to the land He gave to Jacob, where they will build houses, plant vineyards, and dwell safely.

III. Passage Analysis

The point isn't the judgment — it's knowing who God is

The declaration that God will glorify Himself in Sidon gives the sense that they had sinned against His glory. Through His judgments, God would reveal Himself and show that He was hallowed in her. [1]

The line that keeps repeating in this passage is "they shall know that I am the Lord" — everything God does here is aimed at people actually knowing who He is. Sidon's problem wasn't one bad decision; the whole city lived as if God simply wasn't there.

God remembers what He promised

Salvation is not only safety, but a rich inheritance and joy in abundance... What this stresses is the announcement of salvation, explaining the Lord's faithfulness to His covenant — final proof that the Lord never forgets what He has promised, and that it will be fulfilled and realized in its own time and order. [2]

Israel was stuck far from home with nothing, and God told them they would one day come back and build houses and plant vineyards. Houses and vineyards both take years before you see anything from them — God is describing a life settled enough that you can plan ahead.

IV. Reflection Question

Is there a person or a situation right now that you have to carefully work around every day — something that leaves you drained just thinking about it?

In this passage God says the "pricking brier" will one day be gone, and His people will build houses and plant vineyards and live without fear.

References

- [1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-28/>
- [2] Chinese Christian Bible Study, Yau-Chi Tong, Tien Dao Bible Commentary: Ezekiel, <https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT28.htm>